[This telegram is of particular secrecy and should be retained by the authorised recipient and not passed on].

Cypher/OTP.

DEPARTMENTAL DISTRIBUTION.

FROM FOREIGN OFFICE TO WASHINGTON.

No: 3981.
31st August, 1951.

D: 8.10 p.m. 31st August, 1951.

IMMEDIATE.
SECRET.

Addressed to Washington telegram No: 3981 of 31st August
Repeated for information to: Tokyo.
Tamsui.

My immediately preceding telegram.

Japanese Peace Treaty.

Please request State Department to give an assurance that there is no truth in this report.

2. For your own information, a very bad impression would be created here by any arrangements which (contrary to Dulles's assurance to us that the United States Government would discourage the Japanese from any such action) purported to be a formal Peace Treaty with China. Even a formal Peace Treaty between Japan and the Chinese Nationalists signing as the Government of Formosa would be contrary to the spirit of the compromise on China agreed on with Mr. Dulles in London and would be certain to provoke strong Parliamentary criticism. Either of these developments might indeed lead to difficulty about ratification of the Peace Treaty by the United Kingdom. These comments are for your own information only at this stage, though, failing a satisfactory assurance from the State Department that there is no substance to these reports and no intention to depart from Mr. Dulles's previous assurances to us, or from the spirit of our understanding about China, we may have to ask you to make strong and urgent representations.

DISTRIBUTED TO:

Japan and Pacific Department.
China and Korea Department.

JJJJJ

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